

THE SECRETARY OF THE TREASURY

Washington

April 29, 1946

Dear Joe,

I know that I am reflecting the view of all your associates in the Treasury Department when I tell you that we deeply regret your decision to return to private practice.

To us, you have always exemplified that which is finest in the government career service. You started at the bottom of the ladder in the Treasury and through sheer ability, richly blended with high courage and sound judgment, you quickly reached the top level in the Government. As General Counsel of the War Refugee Board, as Assistant General Counsel of the Treasury Department, and, finally, as an Assistant to the Secretary under both Secretary Morgenthau and myself, you have covered yourself and the Department with respect and distinction.

As much as I would like to insist that you remain with the Treasury, my sense of fairness dictates that you be permitted to make your own decision. The records of the Department are clear that it was at our insistence that you gave up your own law practice even before our entry into the war to assist us on the staggering problems then confronting us. It is equally clear that even when you repeatedly requested the opportunity to serve your country in the armed forces, we insisted that you continue vital war work in the Treasury as a civilian. Accordingly, I have no alternative now but to acquiesce in your decision to return to private practice.

I do appreciate your generous offer to lend the Department assistance on special matters from time to time and I am sure that there will be occasions on which we will seek your counsel.

Sincerely,

(Sgd) Fred M. Vinson
Secretary of the Treasury

Mr. Josiah E. DuBois, Jr.
Assistant to the Secretary
U. S. Treasury
Washington 25, D. C.